

How to Source a Good Property and Verify Ownership — EdgeSpark Estate

A due-diligence field guide for property, title, documents, and risk

EdgePark Estate \ Educational guide \ 2026-08-27

Contents

1	Reader note	1
2	1. Define the brief	2
3	2. Source opportunities	3
4	3. Screen quickly	4
5	4. Check the seller identity	5
6	5. Request the document pack	6
7	6. Search official records	7
8	7. Read the title	8
9	8. Verify survey and boundaries	9
10	9. Check litigation and disputes	10
11	10. Check planning and use	11
12	11. Inspect the physical property	12
13	12. Check services and access	13
14	13. Review tenancies	14
15	14. Validate valuation	15
16	15. Understand total cost	16
17	16. Use conditions before payment	17
18	17. Avoid unsafe payment practices	18
19	18. Recognize common red flags	19
20	19. Handle off-plan purchases	20
21	20. Handle land purchases	21
22	21. Handle apartments	22
23	22. Use a decision matrix	23
24	23. Document professional advice	24
25	24. Negotiate with evidence	25
26	25. Prepare the contract	26
27	26. Close and register	27

1 Reader note

This guide is educational information, not legal, tax, financial, valuation, lending, or investment advice. Rules, documents, costs, returns, and market conditions differ by jurisdiction. Before acting, consult appropriately licensed local professionals and verify current official records.

This guide is designed to move from principle to practice. Read the examples as scenarios, not forecasts. Keep an evidence file for every property, decision, assumption, conversation, and payment.

2 1. Define the brief

Purpose. Write location, use, budget, timing, size, condition, access, infrastructure, and return requirements.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

3 2. Source opportunities

Purpose. Use licensed agents, owners, developers, referrals, public listings, professional networks, and site visits.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

4 3. Screen quickly

Purpose. Reject opportunities that fail basic location, price, access, demand, or documentation tests.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

5 4. Check the seller identity

Purpose. Match names, identification, company records, authority, and payment instructions.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

6 5. Request the document pack

Purpose. Ask for title, survey, building approvals, plans, tax evidence, receipts, tenancy, and encumbrance information.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

7 6. Search official records

Purpose. Use the relevant land registry or government authority and retain search receipts and results.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

8 7. Read the title

Purpose. Check tenure, description, parties, boundaries, interests, restrictions, and registration details.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

9 8. Verify survey and boundaries

Purpose. Compare coordinates, beacons, plans, physical occupation, roads, easements, and neighbouring claims.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

10 9. Check litigation and disputes

Purpose. Ask counsel to investigate pending claims, notices, probate issues, family interests, and competing sales.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

11 10. Check planning and use

Purpose. Confirm zoning, development permissions, setbacks, density, environmental rules, and intended use.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

12 11. Inspect the physical property

Purpose. Use independent surveyors, engineers, electricians, plumbers, and specialists as needed.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

13 12. Check services and access

Purpose. Verify water, power, drainage, roads, internet, security, parking, and service charges.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

14 13. Review tenancies

Purpose. Confirm occupants, leases, rent history, deposits, arrears, notices, and handover obligations.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

15 14. Validate valuation

Purpose. Compare independent valuation, recent transactions, replacement cost, income, and marketability.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

16 15. Understand total cost

Purpose. Include legal, search, survey, taxes, registration, agents, repairs, financing, insurance, and reserves.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

17 16. Use conditions before payment

Purpose. Make offer and payment milestones conditional on satisfactory verification.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

18 17. Avoid unsafe payment practices

Purpose. Do not pay cash or to an unrelated account; confirm instructions independently.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

19 18. Recognize common red flags

Purpose. Urgency, missing originals, inconsistent names, unusual discounts, refusal of inspection, and pressure.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

20 19. Handle off-plan purchases

Purpose. Review developer track record, approvals, escrow or safeguards, specifications, delays, and remedies.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

21 20. Handle land purchases

Purpose. Confirm access, planning, survey, community issues, acquisition history, and development feasibility.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

22 21. Handle apartments

Purpose. Review service charges, sinking funds, management rules, common areas, parking, and defects. A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

23 22. Use a decision matrix

Purpose. Score title, location, condition, price, income, risk, liquidity, and professional confidence.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

24 23. Document professional advice

Purpose. Keep written opinions, assumptions, limitations, and follow-up questions.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

25 24. Negotiate with evidence

Purpose. Use defects, comparable evidence, timing, and conditions rather than emotion.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

26 25. Prepare the contract

Purpose. Have a qualified local lawyer draft or review sale, assignment, development, or tenancy documents.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

27 26. Close and register

Purpose. Confirm completion deliverables, possession, originals, filings, taxes, and registration steps.

A durable real-estate decision begins with a clear objective, a defined audience, and a written set of assumptions. In this chapter, translate the idea into evidence you can inspect: location, demand, price, condition, legal status, financing, operating cost, exit route, and the people responsible for each step. Good practice is not about sounding confident; it is about making uncertainty visible early enough to manage it. Use a simple base case, downside case, and upside case. The base case reflects reasonable current evidence. The downside case tests vacancy, delays, higher costs, weaker demand, or a slower sale. The upside case is useful only when it is supported by a specific, defensible driver. Never use the upside case as the only reason to proceed.

Apply this page

- Write the decision in one sentence and name the evidence needed.n- List three assumptions that could be wrong and how you will test them.n- Record the person responsible, deadline, and source for each open question.

